# AWS Enterprise Transformation Playbook

## Business Case Template

Generated: February 12, 2026

# Business Case Template for AWS Transformation

## Executive Summary

Project Name: [Your AWS Transformation Name] Sponsor: [Executive Sponsor Name & Title] Prepared By: [Your Name & Title] Date: [Date] Decision Required By: [Date]

### Overview

[2-3 paragraph summary of the transformation, expected outcomes, and investment required]

### Recommendation

■ Approve - Proceed with AWS transformation ■ Conditional Approval - Approve with modifications ■ Defer - Delay decision pending additional analysis ■ Decline - Do not proceed

### Key Metrics at a Glance

| Metric | Value |
|---|---|
| Total Investment | $[X]M over [Y] years |
| Annual Run-Rate Savings | $[X]M (when fully realized) |
| ROI | [X]% |
| Payback Period | [X] months |
| NPV (10% discount) | $[X]M |
| Strategic Value | High / Medium / Low |

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## 1. Strategic Context

## 1.1 Business Drivers

Why are we considering this transformation?

- [ ] Cost Reduction: Current infrastructure costs are $[X]M annually and growing
- [ ] Agility: Time to market needs to improve from [X] weeks to [Y] weeks
- [ ] Scalability: Current infrastructure cannot support [growth metric]
- [ ] Innovation: Need to enable [AI/ML, IoT, analytics, etc.]
- [ ] Risk Mitigation: End-of-life systems, compliance requirements
- [ ] Competitive Pressure: Competitors moving faster with cloud
- [ ] M&A; Activity: Need to integrate acquired companies quickly

Strategic Alignment: - Corporate Strategy Alignment: [Describe how this supports corporate strategy] - Digital Transformation Roadmap: [Position in overall digital strategy] - IT Strategy: [IT modernization priorities]

## 1.2 Current State Challenges

| Challenge | Impact | Urgency |
|---|---|---|
| Legacy infrastructure | High operational costs | High |
| Slow provisioning | Delays product launches | High |
| Scalability limitations | Cannot support growth | Medium |
| Security/compliance gaps | Risk of breach | High |
| Skills shortage | Difficulty maintaining systems | Medium |

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# 2. Proposed Solution

## 2.1 Solution Overview

Transformation Approach: [Rehost / Replatform / Refactor / Hybrid]

Target AWS Architecture:

```
[Insert high-level architecture diagram or description]
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```
- Compute: ECS/EKS, Lambda, EC2
- Data: RDS, DynamoDB, S3, Redshift
- Networking: VPC, CloudFront, Route 53
- Security: IAM, Secrets Manager, GuardDuty
- Monitoring: CloudWatch, X-Ray
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Migration Strategy: - Wave 1 (Months 1-3): [Low-risk applications] - Wave 2 (Months 4-6): [Medium complexity] - Wave 3 (Months 7-12): [Mission-critical systems]

### 2.2 Scope

In Scope: - [X] applications totaling [Y] servers - [Z] TB of data - [N] users - [List specific systems/applications]

Out of Scope: - [Legacy systems scheduled for decommission] - [On-premise systems with specific requirements]

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## 3. Financial Analysis

### 3.1 Investment Required

| Category | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| AWS Services | $[X] | $[Y] | $[Z] | $[Total] |
| Professional Services | $[X] | $[Y] | $[Z] | $[Total] |
| Software Licenses | $[X] | $[Y] | $[Z] | $[Total] |
| Training | $[X] | $[Y] | $[Z] | $[Total] |
| Internal Labor | $[X] | $[Y] | $[Z] | $[Total] |
| Contingency (15%) | $[X] | $[Y] | $[Z] | $[Total] |
| TOTAL INVESTMENT | $[X] | $[Y] | $[Z] | $[Total] |

## 3.2 Benefits & Savings

| Benefit Category | Annual Value | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Infrastructure Cost Reduction | $[X]M | Reduced data center, hardware, utilities |
| Software License Optimization | $[X]K | Rightsizing, reserved instances |
| Labor Efficiency | $[X]M | Automation, reduced maintenance |
| Productivity Gains | $[X]M | Faster deployments, self-service |
| Avoided Costs | $[X]M | Avoided hardware refresh, EOL migrations |
| Revenue Opportunity | $[X]M | Faster time to market for new products |
| Risk Mitigation Value | $[X]M | Avoided downtime, compliance fines |
| TOTAL ANNUAL BENEFITS | $[X]M | Fully realized by Year [Y] |

## 3.3 Financial Metrics

Net Present Value (NPV): - 5-Year NPV @ 10% discount rate: $[X]M - Interpretation: [Positive = value-creating project]

Return on Investment (ROI): - ROI = (Total Benefits - Total Costs) / Total Costs - [X]% over 5 years - Target: >25%

Payback Period: - [X] months from project start - Target: <24 months

Internal Rate of Return (IRR): - [X]% - Exceeds cost of capital ([Y]%)

## 3.4 Cash Flow Analysis

| Year | Investment | Benefits | Net Cash Flow | Cumulative |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | ($[X]M) | $0 | ($[X]M) | ($[X]M) |
| 1 | ($[X]M) | $[Y]M | $[Z]M | ($[X]M) |
| 2 | ($[X]M) | $[Y]M | $[Z]M | $[X]M |
| 3 | ($[X]M) | $[Y]M | $[Z]M | $[X]M |
| 4 | $0 | $[Y]M | $[Y]M | $[X]M |
| 5 | $0 | $[Y]M | $[Y]M | $[X]M |

# 4. Risk Assessment

## 4.1 Key Risks & Mitigation

| Risk | Probability | Impact | Mitigation Strategy |
|---|---|---|---|
| Migration Complexity | Medium | High | Phased approach, experienced partners, pilots |
| Cost Overruns | Medium | High | Detailed estimation, 15% contingency, governance |
| Skills Gap | High | Medium | Training program, AWS certifications, partners |
| Business Disruption | Low | High | Blue-green deployments, rollback plans, testing |
| Security/Compliance | Low | Critical | AWS compliance programs, security reviews |
| Vendor Lock-in | Medium | Medium | Multi-cloud strategy, portable architectures |
| Change Resistance | High | Medium | Change management, executive sponsorship, quick wins |

## 4.2 Assumptions

- AWS pricing remains stable or decreases
- Internal team availability as planned
- Business requirements remain stable
- No major M&A; activity during transformation

- AWS service availability per SLA (99.9%+)

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# 5. Non-Financial Benefits

## 5.1 Strategic Benefits

| Benefit | Impact | Timeline |
|---|---|---|
| Innovation Enablement | Enable AI/ML, IoT, analytics | Year 1+ |
| Competitive Advantage | Match or exceed competitor capabilities | Year 1 |
| Business Agility | Reduce time-to-market by 50% | Year 2 |
| Global Reach | Enter new markets with AWS regions | Year 1 |
| Talent Attraction | Attract cloud-savvy talent | Year 1+ |

## 5.2 Operational Benefits

- Scalability: Auto-scaling to handle 10x demand spikes
- Reliability: 99.9%+ uptime with Multi-AZ deployments
- Security: Enterprise-grade security, compliance certifications
- Disaster Recovery: RPO <1 hour, RTO <4 hours
- Automation: 80% reduction in manual provisioning tasks

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# 6. Alternative Options Considered

## Option A: Do Nothing (Status Quo)

- Cost: $[X]M over 5 years (existing run rate)
- Pros: No disruption, no investment
- Cons: Increasing costs, technical debt, competitive disadvantage
- Recommendation: ■ Not viable long-term

### Option B: Modernize On-Premise

- Cost: $[X]M investment + $[Y]M annual run-rate
- Pros: Retain control, existing skills
- Cons: Higher TCO, less agility, missed cloud benefits
- Recommendation: ■ More expensive, less strategic value

### Option C: Hybrid Cloud

- Cost: $[X]M investment + $[Y]M annual run-rate
- Pros: Gradual transition, flexibility
- Cons: Complexity, two environments to manage
- Recommendation: ■■ Consider for specific workloads only

### Option D: AWS Cloud (Recommended)

- Cost: $[X]M investment + $[Y]M annual run-rate
- Pros: Best TCO, maximum agility, innovation platform
- Cons: Transformation complexity, change management
- Recommendation: ■ Highest strategic value and ROI

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# 7. Implementation Approach

## 7.1 Timeline

| Phase | Duration | Key Milestones |
|---|---|---|
| Initiation | Months 1-2 | Governance, team, kick-off |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Assessment | Months 1-3 | Current state, readiness, planning |
| Planning | Months 2-4 | Roadmap, wave plans, training |
| Execution | Months 4-18 | Wave migrations, testing |
| Stabilization | Months 18-21 | Hypercare, optimization |
| Optimization | Ongoing | Continuous improvement |

### 7.2 Governance

- Steering Committee: Monthly reviews, major decisions
- Program Manager: Daily oversight, coordination
- Technical Working Groups: Architecture, security, operations
- Change Management: Training, communication, adoption

### 7.3 Success Criteria

- [ ] 100% of in-scope applications migrated
- [ ] >99.9% uptime achieved
- [ ] Cost savings targets met
- [ ] Zero critical security incidents
- [ ] >80% user adoption
- [ ] ROI >25% achieved

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## 8. Recommendation & Decision

### Recommendation

Proceed with AWS transformation based on: - Strong financial returns (ROI: [X]%, Payback: [Y] months) - Strategic alignment with business objectives - Manageable risks with mitigation plans - Competitive necessity

### Decision Required

Approval to: - [ ] Allocate $[X]M budget for Years 1-3 - [ ] Assign [N] FTEs to transformation program - [ ] Engage AWS and system integrator partners - [ ] Proceed with Phase 1: Initiation

Approvers: - [ ] CEO - [ ] CFO - [ ] CIO/CTO - [ ] Business Unit Leaders

Signatures:

______________________________________________________________________

[Executive Sponsor Name], [Title] Date: ___

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[CFO Name], Chief Financial Officer Date: ___

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# Appendices

## A. Detailed Cost Model

[Link to Excel model or detailed breakdown]

## B. Application Inventory

[List of applications in scope]

## C. Technical Architecture

[Detailed architecture diagrams]

## D. Partner Quotes

[Quotes from AWS, system integrators]

## E. Reference Case Studies

[Similar transformations, lessons learned]

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Document Control: - Version: 1.0 - Last Updated: [Date] - Next Review: [Date] - Owner: [Name & Title]